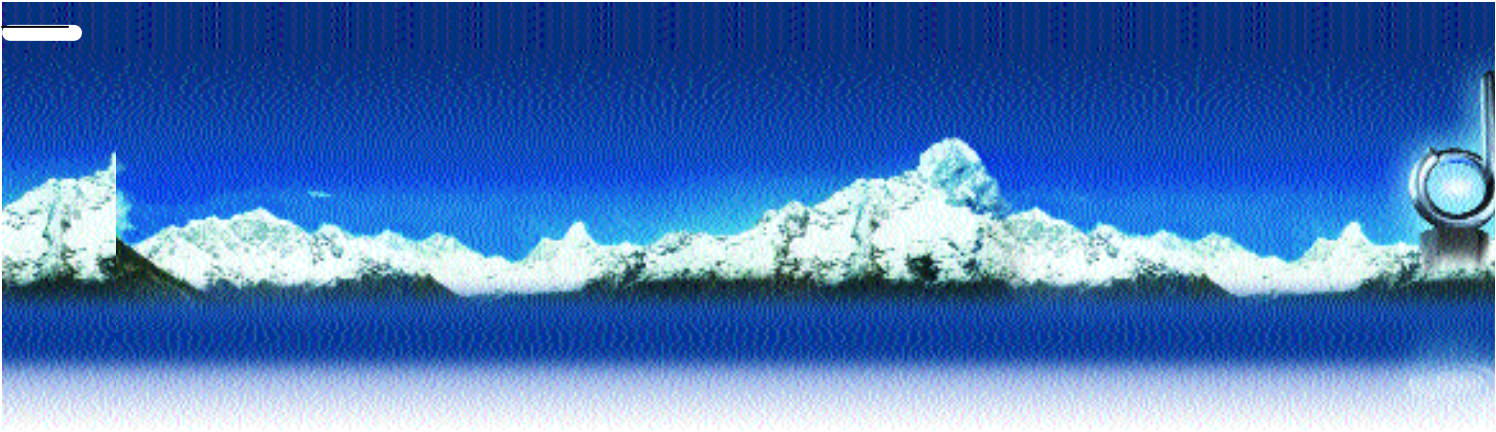
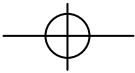




LASER PRINTERS

Laser printers have always been the machines of choice for applications that require large volumes of printouts without sacrificing on print clarity. As a technology, it is more expensive than any other print technology, but when it comes to dealing with text, no other comes close to delivering the speed and quality of a laser printer. This is why they are the *de facto* standard for mass printing in the corporate environment, where the workflow is heavy.

Look sharp

When evaluating the performance of a laser printer, two parameters need to be considered—the print quality and the print speed. The resolution of the laser printer defines the clarity of the printouts and is usually in the range of 300 to 600 dpi for most laser printers. High-end printers boast up to 1200 dpi resolution. While this is significantly lower than inkjet printers, it is adequate for printing text and graphics with reasonable clarity.

Most laser printers have speeds ranging from 15 to 25 pages per minute (ppm) and some others built for enterprise applications go all the way up to 40 ppm. This is the primary specification that defines the cost of the printer. Another very important component is the buffer, which is the memory that holds the print jobs before they get printed—since laser printers are meant to handle large print volumes, they must have a signif-

Nominees		
Name	Contacts	Comments
Samsung ML-1450	Samsung Electronics India Information & Telecommunication Ltd, Ph: 011-6322517	This printer returned very good quality in text and graphics. some interesting features such as ability to print documents on sheet sizes for posters
Hewlett-Packard Laserjet 1200se	Hewlett-Packard India Ltd, Ph: 011- 6826000	This printer offers very good quality for monochrome documents and fared very well even in speed when printing large documents thanks to its 8 MB print buffer

icantly higher amount of buffer memory compared to most dot matrix printers. Entry-level laser printers should feature 2 MB of buffer memory. Depending on specific needs, this capacity can go all the way up to 64 MB. Some enterprise-class printers even have dedicated hard disk drives for large print jobs while they are being processed.



And the award goes to...

The laser printer of choice for 2002 is the Canon LBP1210. This top printer sports a 600-dpi print engine and has a USB as well as parallel interface. With a 250-sheet paper tray, it packs the ability to handle most medium load print jobs. It has a 2 MB print buffer and delivers swift speeds while printing both text as well as monochrome graphics.



Canon LBP1210
Canon India Ltd,
Ph: 011-680 6572

The verdict: Based upon a 600-dpi print engine and sporting both a USB and a parallel interface, this laser printer boasts of commendably high print speeds in the text as well as graphics modes

OFFICE SUITES

Microsoft Office XP

The arrival of Microsoft Office heralded a new age of simplicity for tasks such as word processing and working with spreadsheets. Even though Microsoft Office XP has been around for a year, it is still the best office suite in terms of functionality and features. With a range of intuitive and task-simplifying tools, getting work done in Office XP is easier than ever.

New features such as the task pane give you a dashboard view of everything from wizards to settings and options for the various tools. This arranges all your tools in front of you so that you don't have to dig deep into the menus to look for a particular formatting setting. Small enhancements such as the Smart Paste function let you choose whether you want to copy text along with formatting options or if you want to discard them and use new formatting options. Along with this, it also has multiple

paste options that let you choose from a variety of copied objects, from different formats. You can also perform multiple selections from documents, which helps you manage formatting options and editing tasks with much greater ease. Incorporating a greater number of features such as formatting, fonts, etc has also enhanced the right-click menu. With excellent functionality and intuitive methods of accessing configuration menus, this application incorporates features that let you get more done, faster



Microsoft Office XP
Microsoft

Corporation India Pvt Ltd,
Ph: 011-6292640
The verdict: Still the reigning Office XP integrates wizards task pane and extensive tool offering you the greatest functionality and features for working Office tasks

